

R19 COMMON STATE VERBS

State verbs describe states, such as emotions, possession, senses, or thoughts. They are not usually used in continuous tenses.

MEANING	STATE VERB	SAMPLE SENTENCE
feeling / wanting	like / love	I like / love Italian ice cream.
	need	We really need to spend more time together as a family.
	prefer	Most people prefer summer to winter.
	want	The band wants to become famous and make money.
thinking	believe	I believe your story, but it is rather unlikely.
	doubt	Lots of people doubt that he can do the job properly.
	know	Do you know where we parked the car?
	mean	What do you mean when you say you aren't ready?
	think	What do you think about the proposed policy?
being / existing	understand	Could you speak more slowly? I don't understand you.
	appear / seem	It appears / seems that the house has already been sold.
	exist	Strange creatures exist at the bottom of the sea.
possessing	belong	Excuse me, that book belongs to me.
	have / own	My neighbor has / owns three classic cars.
	include	Did you include Lucy in the guest list?
sensing	feel	Does your leg feel better today?
	hear	I can hear you, but I'm not sure what you're saying.
	hurt	My arm really hurts . I think I should go to see the doctor.
	see	Can you see the blackbird in the bush over there?
	feel	This rug feels so soft. It would be lovely to walk on.
having a quality	smell	Something smells delicious. Is it the soup?
	sound	That sounds like thunder, or is it just fireworks?
	taste	This milk tastes a bit sour. I think it's gone bad.